MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume V | Issue IV | Fall 2015



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FALL 2015 EVENT

Memories & Mementos

Sunday Nov. 1, 2015 at 1:00 p.m. , Adobe Building, 157 Moffett Boulevard

They say "a picture holds a thousand words" and that "every object tells a story." At the Mountain View Historical Association's Fall event, we invite our members to put those sayings into practice! Ever since the MVHA was founded in 1954, one of our most popular programs has been a member show-and-tell session.

Many of our members have artifacts, memorabilia, old photos and stories that connect us to earlier days, and so from time to time, we set aside a meeting when our members can present and share their treasures. These presentations often trigger memories that inspire lively discussions, enhancing the experience. It's been two years since our last show-and-tell program, and we're excited to bring it back!

The success of this program is directly dependent on YOU bringing something to talk about and/or show. Nothing is too trivial or insignificant, so don't be shy!

An added bonus this time around: We will be setting up a "**Memento Preservation Station**" where MVHA volunteers will be on hand to digitally scan any Mountain View-related photos, photographic slides or ephemera (postcards, advertisements, business cards, etc.) that you bring. These images will then be added to our digital archives, ensuring that future generations will have access to them and allowing you to keep the originals.

We will have a sign-up sheet at the event and will try to accommodate as many people as possible. Questions? Email us at info@mountainviewhistorical.org or call (650) 903-6890.

We hope to see you at the Adobe on November 1st!



MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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In Memoriam

E. Gerald (Jerry) Hall
1926 - 2015

News & Notes

President's Message

By Patricia Figueroa
MVHA President



Former Disney Imaginner Bob Gurr speaks at another successful and sold-out MVHA Summer BBQ!

We were very pleased to see so many of you at the BBQ. What a combination, Disneyland and Linda's Parisian burgers! Although I wasn't able to attend, I understand that our special guest speaker, imagineer Bob Gurr, was very interesting. Thank you to Mr. Gurr and to everyone who helped make this event such a great success.

Please note on your calendar that our next Membership Meeting is on Sunday, November 1. Daylight Savings ends and we "fall back" in the early morning that same day—so don't forget to turn back your clock that morning. Instead of a guest speaker, we're hosting a "Memories and Mementos" program, a chance for members to bring your memories to share. The MVHA has hosted these show-and-tell events since we were first founded, and they've always been interesting and popular. The last time, the sign-up sheet was so long that we couldn't get to everyone! We hope many of you will bring memories and mementos to share, and we'll do our best to give everyone who signs up a chance to speak.

In other news, thanks to members Lucas Ramirez and Emily Ramos for helping the MVHA investigate on-line payment systems. Soon you'll be able to join or renew your membership on our website, www.mountainviewshistorical.org. Of course, you'll still be able to renew by check or cash via mail. Our goal is to give members and potential members another option. We're also creating an eventbrite.com account to streamline online ticket purchases and RSVPs for our special events, like the BBQ.

Speaking of events, we hope to see some of you at the City of Mountain View's dedication ceremony for the new Mountain View Veterans Memorial on November 11 at Eagle Park at 650 Franklin Street. The event takes place from 11:00 to 11:30 a.m. at the historic Mountain View Union High School flagpole near the park's pool house. As mentioned in previous editions of our newsletter, we've been working closely with the Veterans Memorial organizers to fund and design a new interpretive sign at the memorial. The sign will explain both the meaning of the memorial and the site's history as the former location of Mountain View Union High School. The sign is slated to be installed after the dedication ceremony, so keep an eye out for it next time you're in Eagle Park!

Financial Report

By John Figueroa
MVHA Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 6/2/15: $ 4, 800.00
- Income: $15,281.75
- Expenses: $6,909.79

Checking Account Balance as of 9/2/15: $13,172.45
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 6/3/15: $83,224.97
- Less matured CD to checking: $11,539.54

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 9/2/15: $71,714.24

History Center Update

By Candace Bowers
MVHA Vice President

New to the History Center:

From Carol Armanini Matteson—photos and articles about the downtown pet parade; class photos from MVUHS and the Highway School.

From June Chichizola—digital copies of family photos; the book San Carlos Stories: An Oral History for the City of Good Living.

From Helene Hughes—an oversized map of Santa Clara County, from 1940.

Join Our History Center Team!
The Mountain View History Center is looking for volunteers to join our team. Help us share Mountain View's historic archives with the public. With your help, we can offer longer hours and greater access to this invaluable resource. For more information, send an email to Candace Bowers at candace.bowers@mountainview.gov or call (650) 903-6890.



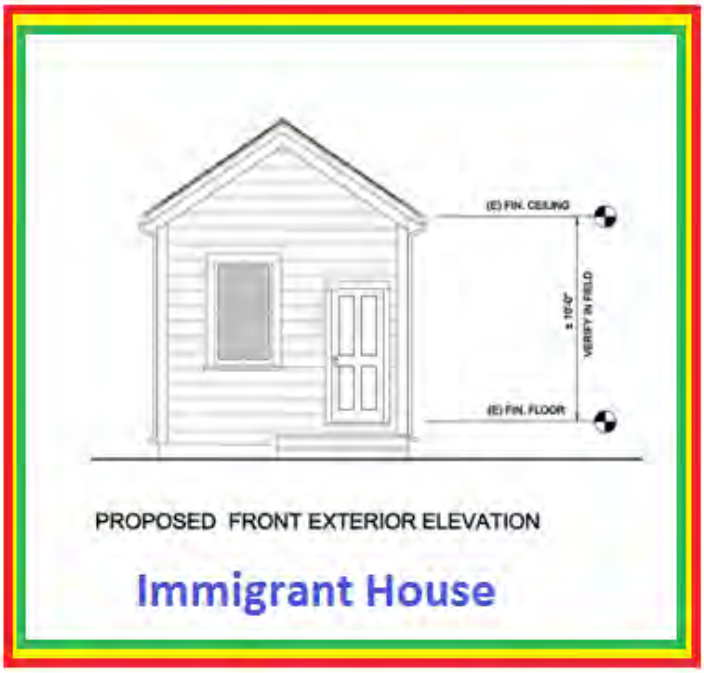
Mountain View History Center
Mountain View Public Library, 2nd Floor – 585 Franklin Street
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Open from 1:00-5:00 p.m. every Tuesday & by appointment.
For more information, call (650) 903-6890.

The Mtn. View History Center's mission is to collect, organize and make available Mountain View historical resources and to promote the City's heritage. It contains the historic archives of both the MVHA and the Mtn. View Public Library. Mtn. View history books and pamphlets are also available for purchase at the History Center.

Immigrant House Update

By Marina Marinovich
MVHA Publicity Chair



October will be a busy month for Immigrant House. On October 14, there will be a Zoning Administrator Hearing at the Mountain View Civic Center. The reason for this meeting is to officially request a historic preservation permit to add Immigrant House to the Mountain View Register of Historic Resources. The house is set to be moved to its new location at 771 N. Rengstorff Avenue in 2016.

Immigrant House will stand as a humble remnant of Old Mountain View's past, commemorating our history and our agrarian roots. The park surrounding the house will be a sanctuary that also celebrates our wildlife and native plants. The plan includes a demonstration garden while also preserving a large heritage tree canopy for current and future generations to enjoy.

On October 15, City of Mountain View Senior Project Manager Rey Rodriguez will give a presentation to the Santa Clara Historical Heritage Commission to apply for a grant for Immigrant House project renovation.

At the October 27 Council Meeting, we are hoping to officially designate the structure as historic.

This three-year process has required a lot of patience and effort. Thanks to all those who have supported us. It couldn't have been done without you!

We will keep you updated here at MVHA, and check the Friends of Immigrant House page on Facebook for all the news.

SUMMER BBQ 2015

Photos by Andrew Quiroz



Disney Imagineer Bob Gurr speaks about his time working for Walt Disney on Disneyland and with Mountain View-based Arrow Development on the park's original ride vehicles.

Giant spinning teacups! Flying elephants! Speeding bobsleds! What do they all have in common? Well, almost anyone who grew up in California over the past six decades can probably tell you they're all popular rides at Disneyland in Anaheim. But what many people don't know is that all of these iconic attractions were engineered in Mountain View by pioneering amusement park ride manufacturer Arrow Development.

To coincide with the 60th anniversary of Disneyland, the Mountain View Historical Association (MVHA) turned our annual summer barbeque into a celebration of Arrow Development and the prominent role the company played in the creation of Disneyland. Most years, the highlight of the Association's barbeque is its nostalgia-flavored menu featuring a re-creation of the beloved Parisian burger from Mountain View's long-lost Linda's Drive-In. But this year, the biggest draw was a very special appearance by legendary Disneyland "imagineer" and ride vehicle designer Bob Gurr.

If you ever admired the sleek design of Disneyland's monorail, or if the first car you drove was one of the park's miniature "Autopia" vehicles, then you've experienced first-hand Gurr's remarkable work. There wasn't an empty seat in the historic Adobe Building when he took the stage to share his memories of working with Walt Disney and Arrow Development.

Gurr fondly recounted his trips to Arrow's plant in Mountain View, where he worked with the company on the design of some of Disneyland's most iconic rides.

Perhaps the most famous Disneyland attraction Gurr worked on with Arrow was a bobsled-themed ride housed within Disney's manmade recreation of the famous Matterhorn Mountain. Gurr shared the story of the ride's creation noting that the use of steel pipe for the track led to the "accidental" invention of the world's first tubular steel track roller coaster. The success of the Matterhorn ride system revolutionized roller coaster design and helped turn Arrow into one of the industry's leading firms.

After Gurr's talk, Robert Ingle, Nicholas Laschkewitsch and Kris Rowberry, members of the American Coaster Enthusiasts (ACE), introduced the trailer for The Legacy of Arrow Development, a new feature-length documentary set to debut later this year. The non-profit organization focuses on the knowledge, enjoyment, and preservation of roller coasters. Portions of Gurr's talk at the barbeque will likely be included in the film.

At the end of the event, MVHA Board Member Nick Perry announced that the organization plans to install a plaque on the sidewalk outside of Arrow's original location at 243 Moffett Boulevard. "Disney theme parks are known for their 'mountain' roller coasters," said Nick. "We're excited to commemorate how a place named Mountain View helped create Disney's first mountain!"



Bob Gurr leads BBQ guests around the original Arrow Development building on Moffett Boulevard.



Kris Rowberry introduced the trailer for the upcoming documentary, *The Legacy of Arrow Development*.



Environmental Planning Commission Robert Cox, MVHA Publicity Chair Mary Kay Marinovich, and Mountain View Mayor John McAlister pause for a photo together.



Folks line up for the MVHA's take on Linda's Parisian burgers, a taste of Mountain View history!



Newsletter Editor Nick Perry (left), Hospitality Chair Helene Hughes (right) with Parisian burger grill-master Cliff Del Carlo (center).



Not an empty seat in the house during the BBQ, with many more sitting outside!



Bob Gurr enjoys some MV sunshine in the garden.



MVHA members enjoying good company and food in the Adobe Building.



BBQ Guests Courtney Laschkewitsch and Daniel Heppner ready to dig into a Parisian burger.



BBQ guest Jindy Garfais asks Bob Gurr a question during Q&A.



Bob Gurr shares his stories with a standing-room-only Adobe Building crowd.

On the Web



We recently started digitally scanning some of the History Center's photographic slide collection. One slide shows the storefront of Stig's Danish Bakery, a popular place to grab a pastry in the Palm Plaza Shopping Center on Castro Street in the 1970s and 1980s. On September 3, we posted the photo to our Facebook page and asked people if they remembered Stig's. They sure did! Here are some of the memories they shared:

"I'm still trying to lose the 20 lbs I gained from Stiggs as a child"

-Dean A.

"I'm convinced that ALL the Cream Puffs I ate at our 10:10 break (all 4 years of high school) is the reason I have a hard time losing weight now! They were so worth it! I really miss those days!"

-Theresa S.

"Yes, I worked there!"

-Madeline D.R.

"Best elephant ears! Our favorite helper, Ruby Purdy!"

-Patricia A.

"The owner was our neighbor. Luanne and I sat their kids. Nice people. Sometimes they would bring home goodies to us."

-Susan D.

"Awesome bear claws in 1975!"

-Ray M.

"Instant flash back to my childhood! Thanks for sharing."

-Michael J.

"My dad would bring home the pink box of Danish Sunday mornings after working grave yard shifts."

-Derek P.

"Loved those apple boats!"

-Jill H.

"Yes, best almond stollen!"

-Cheryl H.

"My grandparents clothing store was in Palm Plaza. Great bakery"

-Kirk V.

"Oh gosh I had forgotten all about this bakery. It was my favorite place to go when I had some extra money!"

-Alice N.

"We bought their awesome strawberry whipped cream cake for our wedding. YUM! "

-Gregory S.P.

Membership

Membership Report

Submitted by June Casey
Membership Chair

Membership as of September 27, 2015

Honored Members	2
Life Members	113
Family Members	76
Single Members	120
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**311**

A warm welcome to our new members!
New Life Member: Emily A. Ramos
New Members: Robert D. Bailey, Chris Costanzo, John T. England, Leslie Montavon, Anne Marie Montavon, Janet Joyce, and Karen Stanford.

Volunteer Opportunities

The MVHA welcomes members interested in lending their time and talent. To sign up for the volunteer opportunities below, send an email to info@mountainviewhistorical.org or call (650) 903-6890.

Event Tabling: Greet the public at the MVHA's table at upcoming events. See Page 8 for upcoming events.

Rengstorff House: The City is currently seeking volunteer docents for the historic Rengstorff House, open Tuesdays, Wednesdays and Sundays for docent-led tours! If you are available *and interested, please send an email to Kristina.Perino@mountainview.gov or call (650) 903-6073.*

Faces of the MVHA

Our organization is nothing without its wonderful members! In this feature, we shine a spotlight on members who shared a bit about themselves at our most recent event.

Robert Cox



Year joined: 2010

Connection to Mtn. View: Commisioner, Environmental Planning Commission since 2013. Vice Chair, 2014. Chair, 2014-2015.

Old Mountain View Neighborhood Steering Committee Vice Chair since 2011. Secretary, 2010.

Twenty year Mountain View resident.

Favorite thing about the MVHA:

The wonderful people who have personal stories to tell about their contributions to Mountain View's history.

Favorite spot in Mtn. View:

Mercy-Bush Park.

MVHA MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mountain View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year.
Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

- ☐ New Membership
- ☐ Membership Renewal
- ☐ Single Membership: *$15/year*
- ☐ Family Membership: *$25/year*
- ☐ Life-time Membership *$200*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

Name: _____

Street Address: _____

City: _____

State: _____ Zip Code: _____

Telephone: _____

Email: _____

Please make checks payable to:
Mtn. View Historical Association

Mail to: Mtn. View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, Ca 94042

FALL / WINTER

November 1
Sunday, 1:00-3:00 p.m.

MVHA Fall Event & Meeting

The Adobe Building - 157 Moffett Blvd.

See Details on Page 1

November 11
Wednesday, 11:00-11:30 a.m.

Veterans Memorial Dedication

Eagle Park - 650 Franklin St.

The City invites the public to attend the dedication of the new Mountain View Veterans Memorial at the Eagle Park flag pole. For more information visit: www.mountainview.gov/events

December 9
Wednesday, 6:00-8:00 p.m.

MVHA Board Meeting

M.V. Library History Center - 585 Franklin St.

Interested members are welcome to attend!

January 31
Sunday, 1:00-3:00 p.m.

MVHA Winter Event & Meeting

The Adobe Building - 157 Moffett Blvd.

This meeting has been rescheduled from its normal February date so as not to conflict with the Super Bowl in Santa Clara. Event details in our next newsletter.

FALL 2015 EVENT



Sunday Nov. 1, 2015 at 1:00 p.m.
Adobe Building, 157 Moffett Boulevard
See Page 1 for Details!

MOUNTAIN REVIEW
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

WEB: www.mountainviewhistorical.org
Email: mvha.newsletter@gmail.com

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for updates on MVHA Events, historic trivia,
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